Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 4 expectations

Grade 4 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 4 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.4.2, L.4.2a, L.4.2b, L.4.2c, L.4.2d

A worked example

Correct this sentence: hamdan asked "can we ride the metro to dubai mall"

1. Capitalise names of people and places: Hamdan, Dubai Mall.
2. Put a comma before the spoken words: asked, "...
3. Capitalise the first word of the speech: Can.
4. The speech is a question, so end it with a question mark inside the quotation marks.

Hamdan asked, "Can we ride the metro to Dubai Mall?"

Questions

1. Which is the correct way to write this book title?

   A. The Story Of The Golden Falcon
   B. The Story of the Golden Falcon
   C. the story of the golden falcon
   D. The story of the golden falcon

2. Which sentence uses capital letters correctly?

   A. My cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the Sea.
   B. My Cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the sea.
   C. My cousin Salem lives in abu dhabi near the sea.
   D. My cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the sea.

3. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

   A. "Let us visit the souq", said Dad.
   B. "Let us visit the souq." said Dad.
   C. "Let us visit the souq," said Dad.
   D. "Let us visit the souq," said dad.

4. Punctuate it: Maryam said please pass the dates

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5. Which sentence has the comma in the right place?
   A. Hamdan wanted to ride the metro, but the train was full.
   B. Hamdan wanted, to ride the metro but the train was full.
   C. Hamdan wanted to ride, the metro but the train was full.
   D. Hamdan wanted to ride the metro but, the train was full.

6. Which sentence needs a comma before "and"? A) Noura packed her bag and went to school. B) Noura packed her bag and her brother packed his.

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7. Which word completes the sentence correctly? The oryx is a ___ animal.
   A. beutiful
   B. beautifull
   C. beautiful
   D. beautyful

8. Which spelling completes the sentence? The mangrove trees grow in ___ water near the coast.
   A. shalow
   B. shallow
   C. shallo
   D. shallew

9. What is the plural of the word family?
   A. familys
   B. familyes
   C. familes
   D. families

10. Correct everything: layla asked can we visit al ain in winter

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11. Explain why Dad has a capital letter in A but dad does not in B. A) I asked Dad for help. B) I asked my dad for help.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.4.1a, L.4.1b, L.4.1c, L.4.1d, L.4.1e, L.4.1f, L.4.1g, L.4.3a, L.4.3c, L.4.4, L.4.4a, L.4.4b, L.4.4c, L.4.5, L.4.5a, L.4.5b, L.4.5c

A worked example

Choose the best word to finish the sentence: The girl ___ kite flew highest won a prize. (who / whose / which)

1. The missing word links the girl to the kite that belongs to her.
2. A word that shows belonging is needed, so choose whose.
3. Check by reading it aloud: The girl whose kite flew highest won a prize.

whose

Questions

1. Which word best completes the sentence? This is the beach ___ we found shells.

   A. where

   B. who

   C. whose

   D. which

2. Which word best completes the sentence? My uncle, ___ drives a bus, knows every road in Sharjah.

   A. where

   B. who

   C. whose

   D. which

3. Which choice completes the sentence with the past progressive? Salem ___ along the creek when it began to rain.

   A. walked

   B. is walking

   C. will be walking

   D. was walking

4. Write the future progressive form of "drive": Tomorrow at noon, we ___ to Al Ain.

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5. Which helping verb best completes the sentence? It is cloudy this morning, so it ___ rain later.

   A. has

   B. might

   C. need

   D. did

6. Choose the best helping verb (must, might, can): At the cycling track there is a rule: cyclists ___ wear a helmet.

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7. Which phrase has the adjectives in the right order?

   A. a big young brown camel

   B. a brown young big camel

   C. a young brown big camel

   D. a big brown young camel

8. Finish the sentence with a phrase that begins with a word like on, under or near: The falcon landed ___.

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9. Which group of words is a fragment?

   A. Omar ran across the sand.

   B. Running across the sand.

   C. The falcon flew home.

   D. Salem opened the door.

10. Fix this run-on sentence in two different ways: The metro was crowded Layla found a seat near the door.

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11. Which sentence uses to, too and two correctly?

    A. Hind has too cousins, and she wants to visit them to.

    B. Hind has to cousins, and she wants too visit them two.

    C. Hind has two cousins, and she wants to visit them too.

    D. Hind has two cousins, and she wants too visit them to.

12. Replace "said" with a more exact word: "Look out!" said Salem. Then explain why your word is better.

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13. Which of these two sentences suits a note to the head teacher, and why? A) Hey, we're gonna be late. B) We will arrive a few minutes late, and we are sorry.

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14. What does "parched" mean in this sentence? After the long walk, the camels were parched, so Khalid gave them water and they drank deeply.

    A. very tired

    B. very hungry

    C. very hot

    D. very dry and thirsty

15. Which reference book would you use to check the meaning of a word, and which would you use to find another word with a similar meaning?

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16. Many English words are built from Greek and Latin roots. The Latin root "port" means "carry". The Greek root "tele" means "far" and "scope" means "to look at". What do the words portable and telescope mean?

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17. Name the kind of figurative language in each sentence and say what it means. A) The desert sand was a golden blanket. B) Hamdan ran as fast as a falcon. C) The maths quiz was a piece of cake.

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18. Which word means almost the same as "enormous"?

    A. huge

    B. tiny

    C. ordinary

    D. narrow

19. Say in your own words what this proverb means: Many hands make light work.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.4.1, W.4.2, W.4.3, W.4.4, W.4.5, W.4.7, W.4.9, W.4.10, SL.4.1, SL.4.2, SL.4.3, SL.4.4, SL.4.6

A worked example

Put these sentences in order to make instructions for planting a tree: A) Then water it every day. B) First, dig a small hole in the soil. C) Finally, watch it grow. D) Next, place the seedling in the hole.

1. Look for the order words: First, Next, Then, Finally.
2. First comes B (dig the hole), because you cannot plant before there is a hole.
3. Next comes D (place the seedling), then A (water it), and Finally C (watch it grow).

B, D, A, C

Questions

1. Which order puts these sentences into a short story? A) At last, she found the key under the cushion. B) One evening, Noura could not find her house key. C) She searched the hall, the kitchen and her bag. D) She smiled and put it safely on its hook.

   A. A, B, C, D

   B. B, A, C, D

   C. B, C, A, D

   D. C, B, A, D

2. Write one sentence that states your opinion on this question: Should every classroom have a reading corner?

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3. Make a plan for an opinion paragraph: "Every classroom should have a plant." Write your opinion, two reasons and one example for each reason.

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4. Which sentence does not belong in a paragraph about falcons?

   A. Falcons have sharp eyesight.

   B. Falcons can fly very fast.

   C. Falcons hunt from the sky.

   D. My cousin has a red bicycle.

5. Which linking phrase best completes the paragraph? Mangroves protect the coast. ___, they give young fish a safe place to grow.

   A. Suddenly

   B. However

   C. In addition

   D. Instead

6. Join the two sentences with a linking word: Camels store fat in their humps. They can travel far without food.

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7. Which opening is better for a story?

   A. One morning, Hind heard a tapping sound from the garden wall.

   B. There was a girl.

   C. This story is about a girl.

   D. A girl lived somewhere.

8. Revise this sentence by adding at least two details: The boat went on the creek.

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9. Write a concluding sentence for this paragraph: The Dubai Metro is fast and clean. Passengers can reach many parts of the city without sitting in traffic. Trains arrive every few minutes.

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10. Edit this paragraph (there are several mistakes): yesterday we visit the date farm. we picked many dates they was sweet.

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11. Plan a short story called "A Trip to the Hajar Mountains" with a family. Write one sentence for the beginning, one for the middle and one for the end.

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12. Why does it help to make a plan before you write a story? Give one reason.

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13. Speaking and listening (parent task). First read a short book or article about the Hope Probe together (one chosen by an adult). Then say to your child: "Let us talk about what we read. We will take turns. I will tell you one thing I found interesting, and you ask me a question about it. Then you tell me one thing, and I will ask you a question about it. Let us keep to the topic and not interrupt each other." Do three turns each.

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14. Listening, part one (parent task). Read this talk aloud once, calmly and clearly: "We should plant mangroves near our beach. Mangrove roots hold the sand, so the shore does not wash away. Young fish hide in the roots, so there are more fish for fishers. The trees also give shade to visitors." Then say: "Tell me in your own words what this talk was about."

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15. Listening, part two (parent task). Read Salem's talk aloud again. Then ask: "What does Salem want? Give me two reasons he gives."

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16. Speaking (parent task). Say to your child: "Please give me a talk of about one minute called My Favourite Place in the UAE. Pretend you are speaking to your class, so use formal English, for example I would like to tell you about ... Include two or three facts, and speak clearly at a steady pace." Listen without interrupting.

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17. Research (parent task, with an adult). Choose one UAE animal, such as the oryx, the camel or the falcon. Find four facts from two sources, such as a library book and, if an adult sits with you, a trusted website (the website is optional). Write a short report of three or four sentences in your own words and say where each fact came from.

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18. Write two sentences about the same animal as a note for a younger child. Use simple words and a friendly tone.

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19. Read this paragraph: "The Arabian oryx is a pale antelope with long straight horns. Its light coat reflects the heat of the sun. It can live for a long time without drinking, because it gets water from the plants it eats." Write three sentences that answer: Why is the oryx well suited to desert life? Use at least two facts from the paragraph as evidence.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. B. The Story of the Golden Falcon. Capitalise the first word and the important words of a title, but small words like of and the stay small in the middle. If your child chose A, they gave a capital to every word, including 'Of' and 'The'.
2. D. My cousin Salem lives in Abu Dhabi near the sea. Capitals go on names of people and places, but not on a general word like sea. If your child chose B, they capitalised 'Cousin', a general word. If they chose C, they forgot the capitals on Abu Dhabi.
3. C. "Let us visit the souq," said Dad. The comma goes inside the closing quotation mark, and Dad is used as a name so it keeps its capital letter. If your child chose A, they put the comma outside the quotation marks. If they chose D, they wrote 'dad' with a small letter.
4. Maryam said, "Please pass the dates." A comma comes before the spoken words, the speech starts with a capital letter, and the full stop sits inside the quotation marks. Ask: which words did Maryam actually say aloud?
5. A. Hamdan wanted to ride the metro, but the train was full. Put a comma before a joining word like 'but' when it links two complete parts: 'Hamdan wanted to ride the metro' and 'the train was full'. If your child chose B, they put a comma in the middle of the first part, after 'wanted'.
6. B needs the comma: 'Noura packed her bag, and her brother packed his.' Here 'and' joins two complete parts about different people. In A, 'and' joins two actions by the same person, so there is no comma. Ask: can each part stand alone as a sentence?
7. C. beautiful. Beautiful comes from beauty: change the y to i and add ful with one l. If your child chose B, they added 'full' with two l's. If they chose D, they kept the y instead of changing it to i.
8. B. shallow. Shallow has two l's in the middle and ends with 'ow'. If your child chose A, they wrote only one l. If they chose C, they ended the word with 'o' instead of 'ow'.
9. D. families. When a word ends in a consonant plus y, change the y to i and add es, so family becomes families. If your child chose A, they only added s. If they chose B, they kept the y before the es.
10. Layla asked, "Can we visit Al Ain in winter?" Check four things: capitals for Layla and Al Ain, a comma before the speech, a capital for Can, and a question mark inside the quotation marks. Ask: which words did Layla say aloud?
11. In A, Dad is used as a name (it stands in for the person's name), so it takes a capital letter. In B, 'my dad' is a general word for a family member with 'my' in front, so it stays small. Ask: could you swap in a name instead, like Hamdan?

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. A. where. Use 'where' for a place, and the beach is a place. If your child chose B, they used 'who', which is only for people. If they chose C, they used 'whose', which shows that something belongs to someone.
2. B. who. Use 'who' for a person, and 'my uncle' is a person. If your child chose A, they used 'where', which is for places. If they chose C, they used 'whose', which needs a thing that is owned to come next.

3. D. was walking. Use was or were plus an -ing word for something that was going on when another thing happened. If your child chose A, they used 'walked', which does not show the walking was still going on. If they chose B, 'is walking' is the wrong time.
4. will be driving. Use 'will be' plus an -ing word for something that will be going on at a set time, here tomorrow at noon. Ask: is the sentence about now, or about tomorrow?
5. B. might. Might shows that rain is possible but not certain, which fits a cloudy morning. If your child chose A, 'has rain' is not a correct verb. If they chose D, 'did rain' is about the past, but the word 'later' points to the future.
6. must. It shows a rule that has to be followed, while 'might' or 'can' would make a helmet sound like a choice. Ask: is wearing a helmet a rule here, or just a choice?
7. A. a big young brown camel. Adjectives go in the order size, then age, then colour, so 'a big young brown camel'. If your child chose D, they put the colour before the age. If they chose C, they put the size last.
8. Answers vary. A good answer starts with a place word such as on, under or near and tells where, for example 'The falcon landed on Khalid's glove.' Ask: which word starts your phrase, and does it tell us where?
9. B. Running across the sand. A sentence needs to say who is doing something. 'Running across the sand' does not say who is running, so it is a fragment. If your child chose A, they may have picked the sentence with the most action, but 'Omar ran across the sand' is complete.
10. Two ways to fix it. One: use a full stop, 'The metro was crowded. Layla found a seat near the door.' Two: use a comma and a joining word, 'The metro was crowded, but Layla found a seat near the door.' Ask: where does the first idea end?
11. C. Hind has two cousins, and she wants to visit them too. To means towards, too means also, and two is the number. If your child chose A, they used 'too' for the number and 'to' for also. If they chose D, they swapped 'too' and 'to' at the end.
12. Example: "Look out!" shouted Salem (shouted shows how loudly he spoke; warned also works). A good answer gives an exact word and says what it shows that 'said' does not. Ask: what does your word tell us about how Salem spoke?
13. It is polite, formal English, which suits a note to a head teacher. A is casual talk for friends. Ask: would you say 'gonna' to your head teacher?
14. D. very dry and thirsty. The clue is in the sentence: the camels drank deeply, so they needed water, and parched means very dry and thirsty. If your child chose A, they may have thought of the long walk and picked tired, but the drinking is the clue.
15. A dictionary (or glossary) gives the meaning of a word, and a thesaurus gives words with a similar meaning. Ask: if you want a different word for 'big', which book would you open?
16. Portable means able to be carried, because port means carry. A telescope is an instrument for looking at things far away, because tele means far and scope means to look at. Ask: which part of each word gave you the clue?
17. A is a metaphor: it says the sand IS a blanket, with no 'like' or 'as'. B is a simile: it compares using 'as ... as'. C is an idiom: it means very easy, not real cake. Ask: which sentence uses 'like' or 'as' to compare?
18. A. huge. Enormous means very big, and so does huge. If your child chose B, they picked tiny, which is the opposite. Ask: does the word mean the same as enormous, or the reverse?

19. When many people share a job, it gets finished more easily and quickly. A good answer says that sharing makes the work lighter, in the child's own words. Ask: when did helping together make a job faster for you?

Section 3: Writing

1. C. B, C, A, D. A story starts with the problem (B), then the search (C), then the solution (A), then the ending (D). If your child chose B, they put the key being found before the search for it.
2. A good answer is one complete sentence that says clearly what you think and ends with a full stop. Example: I believe every classroom should have a reading corner because it makes reading feel welcoming. Ask: can someone tell what you think from this sentence?
3. A good plan has the opinion, two different reasons, and an example for each. Example: Reason 1, plants make the air feel fresher (the aloe plant by the window). Reason 2, caring for a plant teaches responsibility (a pupil waters it each Monday). Ask: what is the example for each reason?
4. D. My cousin has a red bicycle. Every sentence in a paragraph should be about the main topic, and the bicycle is not about falcons. If your child chose A, B or C, ask them to read that sentence again, because each one gives a fact about falcons.
5. C. In addition. 'In addition' adds another fact, and the second sentence gives another way mangroves help. If your child chose B, they used 'However', which turns to a contrast. If they chose A, 'Suddenly' is for a surprise, which does not fit.
6. Example: Camels store fat in their humps, so they can travel far without food. A comma and a joining word such as 'so' or 'because' links the two ideas. Ask: does your joining word show why or what happened as a result?
7. A. One morning, Hind heard a tapping sound from the garden wall. A good opening names a person, a time and something interesting that makes the reader want to know more. If your child chose B, the opening 'There was a girl' gives no detail that makes a reader curious.
8. Answers vary. A good answer keeps the same idea and adds at least two details, such as size, colour, time or place. Example: The small wooden boat drifted gently along the quiet creek at sunrise. Ask: which two details did you add?
9. A good answer sums up the main idea and does not add a new topic. Example: This is why the metro is a good choice for travelling around the city. Ask: does your last sentence bring the whole paragraph together?
10. Yesterday we visited the date farm. We picked many dates. They were sweet. The fixes are capital letters at the start of sentences, 'visited' for the past, full stops between sentences, and 'were' instead of 'was'. Ask: can you read it aloud and listen for mistakes?
11. A good answer has three sentences: a beginning that sets the scene, a middle with a problem or an exciting event, and an end that solves it. Answers will vary. Ask: what happens that makes the family need to solve something?
12. Any sensible reason works, for example: the ideas are in order before writing, so the story is clear and stays on the topic. Ask: what could go wrong if you started writing with no plan?
13. Listen for: the child has read the text first, takes turns, listens without interrupting, asks questions linked to what was just said (for example: Why do you say that?), adds ideas that stay on the topic, and speaks politely. Finish with one specific thing the child did well.

14. A good retell keeps the main ideas in the child's own words and in order: the speaker wants mangroves planted near the beach, and gives reasons about the sand, the fish and the shade. It does not need the exact words. Ask: what was the very first reason you heard?
15. Salem wants mangroves planted near the beach. Any two reasons are fine: the roots hold the sand so the shore stays in place; young fish hide in the roots so there are more fish for fishers; the trees give shade to visitors. Ask: which reason is the strongest, and why?
16. A good talk has an opening that names the place, two or three facts in a sensible order, a closing sentence, a clear voice at a steady pace, and complete sentences in formal English. Give kind, specific praise for one thing done well, then ask: what would you try differently next time?
17. A good answer shows four facts from two sources, in the child's own words (not copied), with each source named, for example the book title. The facts must be true for the animal chosen. Ask: where did you find each fact?
18. A good answer is two complete sentences with simple words, a friendly tone and true facts, so it suits a younger reader. Example: The oryx is a pale, strong animal. It can live in the hot desert for a long time without a drink! Ask: would a six year old understand every word?
19. A good answer is in the child's own words and uses the paragraph: the pale coat reflects the sun's heat, and the oryx gets water from the plants it eats so it can go a long time without drinking. Ask: which two facts from the paragraph did you use as evidence?